

Parks Department Meeting August 19th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RWNtr-tT_Us
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Muncie Parks and Recreation Board: Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: Tuesday, August 19, 2025

Audience: Community Members, Local Journalists, Policy Researchers

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Note: No statutory public hearings or separate committee work sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called to order the Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting on Tuesday, August 19, 2025, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:33.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** James Leton, Early, Shannon Powers, and Brad Marshall.
 - **Absent:** Chandra Parks (excused due to another commitment).

- **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks, but led by board leadership (identified as presiding/facilitating via meeting cues).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening roll call and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the July meeting were approved with no discussion or revisions by voice vote 00:01:22.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

A. Superintendent Report (Carl Malone) 00:01:37

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Allendale Park:** Preparations underway for the IU Big Volunteer Day on September 12. Heavy equipment has been used over 4<U+2013>5 days to remove obsolete rubber mulch. An individual from CRG (Travis) is scheduled to assist tomorrow. Future work includes a new roof on the shelter house, replacement basketball backboards and rims, filling small cracks, and painting playground equipment.
 - **Staffing Update:** Introduced new Program Director Mark White, who has a background with the Muncie Boys Club, Ivy Tech (Upper Bound), and Boys and Girls Club of Ohio, and previously participated in the board's first summer youth program at age 12<U+2013>13.
 - **Tuhey Pool:** Closes to the public over Labor Day weekend; annual "Dog Day" event (Drill in the Pool) follows the following week. Draining and minor repairs slated for late September. Bud and Moore Engineering sending quotes for overall pit renovations.
 - **Thomas Park:** Restroom renovations are underway. Basketball courts to receive minor painting/touch-ups this year, with a major overhaul scheduled for next year. Splash pads close in late September; water is temporarily shut off due to water line work at the new bathroom house.
 - **Riverview Park:** Restroom construction timeline to be determined; work may occur simultaneously with Thomas Park. Splash pads close in late September. General ongoing maintenance includes addressing geese populations at Tuhey and Riverview.
 - **Westside Park:** Positive community feedback regarding the skate park. Basketball court requires a major renovation/overhaul (floodplain committee approval takes 3<U+2013>6 months), but immediate minor work includes painting lines and replacing rims/nets. Softball field upgrades include installing a ready scoreboard

(pending power source change/lighting upgrades) with interest from girls' softball leagues for next season.

- **Heekin Park:** Minor basketball court work completed over the summer with Zion Strong and his team. Portable lights were used for a tournament; permanent/portable lights will remain operational for community safety following positive feedback. New park signs ordered for 12th Street (aluminum structure, approx. \$6,000 for Heekin; smaller templates for Jack's Park at approx. \$500). Tennis/pickleball court conversion discussions ongoing with the neighborhood association.
- **Storm Damage & Trees:** Following July storms, several fallen and dead trees remain to be cleared (e.g., Westside Park tree fall, McCullum Park trees where ground holds standing water and heavy equipment got stuck). The board is coordinating with the urban forestry board.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None specifically during this report.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.

B. Programming Report & Event Approvals (Mark White) 00:16:46

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark White, Program Director.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Summer Wrap-Up:** Muncie Teen Internship Program completed successfully on July 18, 2025. Baseball/softball camps with Randy O'Connor (Barn Academy) at Gamebridge Field, youth basketball leagues, Black Expo youth basketball tournament (Aug 1 at Heekin Park), and the Walmart backpack drive (July 22 at McCullum Park cabin) all concluded successfully.
 - **Fall Programming:** MPD vs. MFD baseball game scheduled for Saturday, August 23 (10 AM-2 PM). Barn Academy Slow Pitch Baseball League running Tuesday/Wednesdays from Sept 16 to Oct 29 at Gamebridge Field. Trunk or Treat scheduled for October 25 (6-8 PM) to avoid conflict with Ball State University Homecoming (Oct 13-18); co-sponsored with DE Recreation/Catering, Boys & Girls Club, and Walmart South (targeting 800 hot dog meals). Winterwear Drive planned for November 4 at McCullum Cabin.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report.

C. 00:20:23 Event Approval: Ashley Duke LLC <U+2013> Back-to-School Youth Basketball Tournament

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark White / Ashley Duke LLC.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to host a free youth basketball tournament (elementary through 9th grade) at Heekin Park on September 6<U+2013>7. Includes 3 volunteers for

security, 3 certified vendors, use of a score table, and a DJ pop-up tent.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:22:45.
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D. **Prairie Creek Report & Event Approvals (Misty Rants)** 00:23:20

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Misty Rants, Interim Operations Manager.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Provided a one-month operational update: successfully assisted in relocating an injured juvenile bald eagle with the Indiana DNR; addressed major campground inspection items; repaired vehicles and equipment; regained access to the Prairie Creek Reservoir Facebook page.
 - Adjusted hours of operation due to seasonal staff returning to college.
 - Met with the "Friends of Prairie Creek Reservoir" on Saturday to discuss future events and collaborations.
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E. **00:26:05 Event Approval: Delaware County Raccoon Hunting Club**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Misty Rants.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request from the hunting club (located near the boat launch) to utilize City of Muncie bleachers for an annual event on August 27<U+2013>28. The board noted standard rental fees apply, with staff (Carl Malone/Nikki) to review potential travel/out-of-town surcharges and equipment availability.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled/Deferred pending staff fee review.
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F. **00:28:15 Event Approval: Steve Ogle <U+2013> Celebration of Life Annual Event**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Misty Rants / Steve Ogle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual memorial concert/celebration of life scheduled for August 31 (2 PM to 10 PM) at the beach area, expecting 150<U+2013>200 attendees with a food truck ("Neighborhood Pizza"), stage, and bleachers.
 - **Deliberation:** The board emphasized that formal security must be required for an event of this size on a public Sunday.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (pending security details, fee verification, and schedule coordination) 00:31:06.
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G. **00:31:24 Event Approval: Security Officer Brian Griffin <U+2013> Campground Movie Night**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brian Griffin, Security Officer / Misty Rants.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to host a free family movie night and hot dog cookout in the campground on the last Saturday of next month (September 27) utilizing remaining account funds to give back to the community.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved by Voice Vote** (conditionally approved pending submission of an event application) [00:34:26](#).
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H. [00:34:52](#) **Prairie Creek Infrastructure & Security Update**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Misty Rants, Carl Malone, and Sam (Security Pros).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Addressed recent traffic incidents, trespassing, and verbal confrontations with staff at Northshore Campground restrooms.
 - Sam from Security Pros presented a \$14,000 project proposal for Northshore Campground: installing a camera at the restroom awning/entry and equipping men's and women's restroom doors with key fob access readers restricted 24/7 to campers/boaters. Discussion covered fob inventory (300 fobs), cloud accessibility, vandalism-resistant domes, and potential grant opportunities.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Comments and inquiries from board members regarding budget line items and recurring subscription costs.
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I. [00:52:21](#) **Friends of Prairie Creek Report (Charlene)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Charlene, Friends of Prairie Creek President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported on recent community feedback, proposed future events including a Halloween Bash on October 18 (decorations, hayride, costume contest, and a kids' Halloween dance in the community building from 8 to 10 PM), a "Let's Go Fishing" kid-friendly activity, and future ideas like a campground flea market/rummage sale fundraiser. Campers also raised concerns regarding speeding cars, potential winter storage, playground updates, and Wi-Fi.
 - **Deliberation:** Board members discussed the challenges of handling funds without a dedicated 501(c)(3). Board member Brad Marshall offered to draft a 501(c)(3) application to formalize a broad "Friends of Muncie Parks and Recreation" nonprofit group to support fundraising across all city parks.
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J. [00:31:21](#) **Old Business: Prairie Creek Rate Reviews (Campsites & Docks) & Winter Storage**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Marshall / Board Members.

- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Reviewed ongoing negotiations with Indiana American Water regarding future allowances for campsites and docks. Electrical billing data for Prairie Creek was presented, noting summer monthly averages exceeding \$11,000 (peak of \$15,000 in August), leading to discussion of a potential \$200 annual electrical surcharge per campsite.
 - Discussed separating boat launch fees from dock rentals.
 - Keith Addison (Commodore, Muncie Sailing Club) spoke regarding the sailing club's self-funded operations (51 docks, 42 paid, 8 day sailors, 40 kayak stickers) and requested that current dock fee structures (\$500) remain consistent given their low municipal impact and self-maintenance.
 - **Winter Storage Policy Vote:** Discussed offering 2025 winter storage. A motion was made and seconded to make 2025 winter storage available to all current campers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - **Motion to offer 2025 winter storage to all current campers: Passed on Roll Call Vote (4-0) 00:47:25:**
 - James Leton: Yes
 - Mark Irvin: Yes
 - Shannon Powers: Yes
 - Brian Marshall: Yes
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K. 01:47:42 New Business: Multi-Use Trails Maintenance Plan

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed an initial draft plan from Flatland for the long-term maintenance and management of multi-use trails involving local groups (Mid Indiana Trails, Redlands Conservancy, local foundations). The board noted that formal approval of trail expansions must wait until written approval is secured from Indiana American Water.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:52:34 Mike Foster (Indiana):** Addressed the long-standing holding tank/sewer infrastructure issue at Prairie Creek, questioned the efficiency of past security gate expenditures, and emphasized the need to align rate structures with final determinations from Indiana American Water.
- **02:03:01 Joanne Hammond:** Inquired about boat launch fee structures and announced a donation of a "Take a bag, leave a bag" metal litter station for the windsurf beach on behalf of *Prairie Creek Reservoir Uncensored*.
- **02:07:15 Unidentified Resident:** Discussed lake usage dynamics, arguing that pontoon boats create minimal wake/fuel consumption compared to high-powered wake boats and

speedboats, and suggested doubling daily/annual launch fees to deter disruptive watercraft.

- **02:10:38 Tasha Barnes Griffin (308 North Mangrove Lane):** Spoke on behalf of the Muncie Chapter of Indiana Black Expo, congratulated Carl Malone on receiving the B. Moten Foster Community Service Award at the IBE corporate luncheon on July 28, thanked city leadership and police for a safe summer celebration at Heekin Park, praised the addition of basketball court lights, and shared positive feedback regarding family reunion cabin rentals and the YWCA teen summer internship program.
 - **02:14:21 Caleb Schwarz (Ball State Student / Urban Planning):** Provided an update on the Muncie Skatepark legal graffiti wall initiative. Reported 96% community support from a survey of over 200 respondents, \$500 raised (seeking BSU match and Patronosity/local grant options), secured lockers ready for powder coating, and outlined a budget of approx. \$3,000 for installation. Requested to be placed on next month's agenda to present final proposed rules, signage, and a maintenance plan.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Reminder of the upcoming "Drool in the Pool" dog swim event at Tuhey Pool on September 6. Next regular board meeting scheduled for the following month.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned upon a motion made and approved **02:28:42**.
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